

Anaconda partners with Microsoft to accelerate open source adoption

Anaconda, Inc. has announced a collaboration with Microsoft to enable customers to confidently access Anaconda's curated library of open source packages within Microsoft Cloud hosted products and services, including Azure services like Azure machine learning, as well as GitHub services such as GitHub Codespaces and GitHub Actions, without the requirement of a separate license¹.

"We are committed to making it easy to use Anaconda everywhere, and that includes inside Microsoft's cloud," said Peter Wang, CEO and co-founder of Anaconda. "By combining Anaconda's package dependency manager and curated open source repository with Microsoft's cloud products, data scientists and developers can use tools they know and trust with the peace of mind that they do not have to worry about additional licensing."

According to the company, organisations that capitalise on the innovation from thousands of makers and contributors in the open source community have a competitive advantage and are able to accelerate projects that would typically take years. This collaboration expands the availability of key open source data science tools across platforms and sets enterprises up for greater success by making it simpler for users to focus on end results.

Anaconda said it has committed to provide Microsoft with a standard SBOM, using software package data exchange (SPDX) specifications, which will allow Microsoft to verify the components, licensing, and provenance of open source packages and libraries in the Anaconda repository.



While RISC-V is an open standard and there's a fair share of open source RISC-V cores available, many commercial cores are closed source. Zhang Jianfeng, president of Alibaba Cloud Intelligence, announced at the 2021 Apsara Conference that T-Head had open sourced four RISC-V-based Xuantie series processor cores, namely, Xuantie E902, E906, C906, and C910, as well as related software and tools.

The RTL for the four cores has been released on T-Head Semiconductor's GitHub account under the Apache 2.0 license. Each repository has its own instruction and code. Alibaba also highlighted software support for its RISC-V cores with AliOS, RT-Thread, FreeRTOS, Linux, and Android. It claims to have shipped over 2.5 billion Xuantie cores so far.

Apiiro's open source software toolkit to combat dependency confusion attacks

Apiiro, the application risk management provider, has announced the release of the Dependency Combobulator, a modular and extensible open source toolkit to detect and prevent dependency confusion attacks.

The Dependency Combobulator allows organisations to safeguard against this



newly uncovered type of risk, which has been on the rise this year as a key vector in supply chain attacks targeting dependencies within software packages. The company said this new solution is a critical element in the approach to securing the software development lifecycle to prevent both direct and supply chain attacks.

Dependency confusion compromises the open source software (OSS) ecosystem by tricking end users, developers and automation systems into installing a malicious dependency instead of the correct one they intended to install, compromising their software.

Apiiro's Dependency Combobulator enables a flexible approach to analyse and automate release workflows that can be evaluated against different sources such as GitHub packages and can be extended to consider additional registries such as JFrog Artifactory. The Dependency Combobulator, aimed to be used by the AppSec practitioner, is a Python based toolkit that supports both the npm and maven package management schemes out-of-the-box, and enables easy extension into other package management systems. It provides improved extensibility that helps organisations to quickly adapt to new types of dependency attacks.

The Dependency Combobulator is pluggable and can be baked into an enterprise's application security program and release cycle in an automated way. It can be plugged into several interaction junctions within an enterprise software development lifecycle, providing actionable insights to fit multiple use cases.

Intel open sources ControlFlag to automatically detect errors in code

Intel Labs' Machine Programming Research (MPR) team, working to improve software developer productivity and quality, has announced the open source availability of ControlFlag. Designed late last year, ControlFlag is a self-supervised idiosyncratic pattern detection system, which learns typical patterns that occur in the control structures of high-level programming languages, such as C/C++, by mining these patterns from open source repositories (on GitHub and other version control systems). It then applies learned patterns to detect anomalous patterns in the user's code.